

VELOCITY
COMICS



001

VOLUME ONE

ICE & INFERNO

FROSTBORN. FIRECROWN.
ONE PATH. NO SURVIVORS.

NEEL





FIFTY YARDS AWAY...

KABOOM!!

WHAT
THE---!?

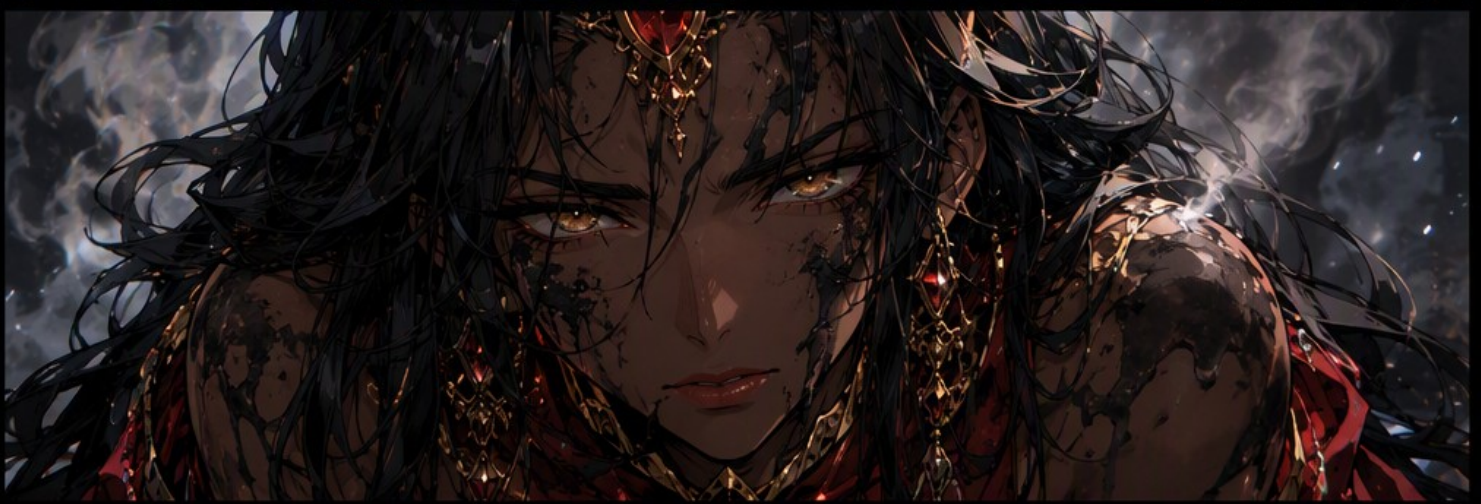
SOMEONE
JUST BURST
THROUGH.

THAT
PRESENCE...

IT CAN'T
BE...

IDENTITY
UNKNOWN.

POWER
LEVEL...
OFF THE
SCALES.



THAT ALL
YOU GOT,
FIRE PRINCESS?

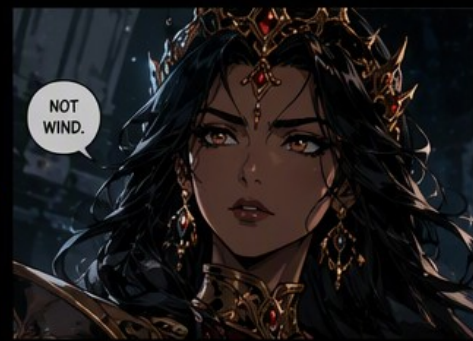
...HMPH.



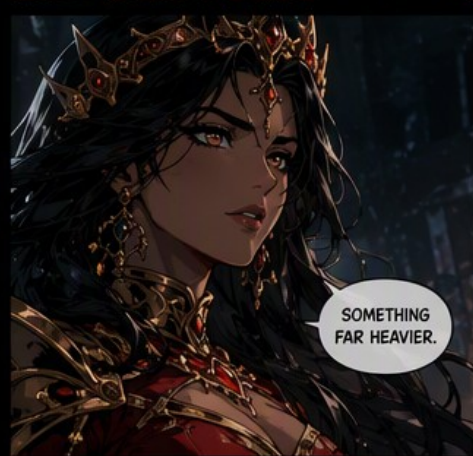
GUESS THE
LEGENDS ARE
EXAGGERATED
AFTER ALL.



...WHAT
WAS THAT?



NOT
WIND.



SOMETHING
FAR HEAVIER.



THE ICE—
IT'S
VIBRATING.

VRRMMMMMMM...

MACHINERY.



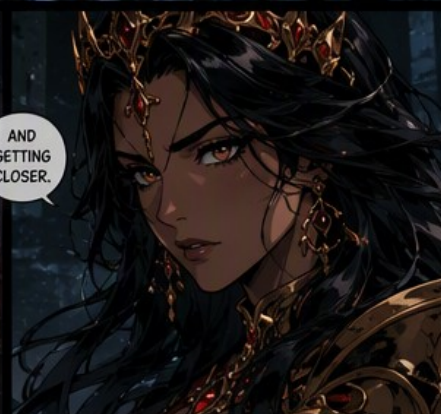
DEEP
BELOW.



SOMETHING
BIG.



VRRRRMMMMMM...



AND
GETTING
CLOSER.



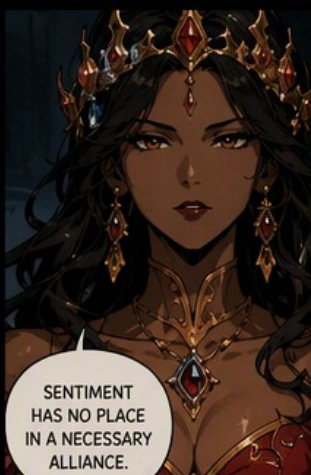
YOU WEREN'T
EXAGGERATING
ABOUT THE
TEMPERATURE.

YOU GAVE ME
A THIN SHIRT.

YOU ALSO
WORE LEATHER
IN A GLACIAL
FORTRESS.



I'M
SURPRISED
YOU AGREED
TO MEETING
HERE.



SENTIMENT
HAS NO PLACE
IN A NECESSARY
ALLIANCE.



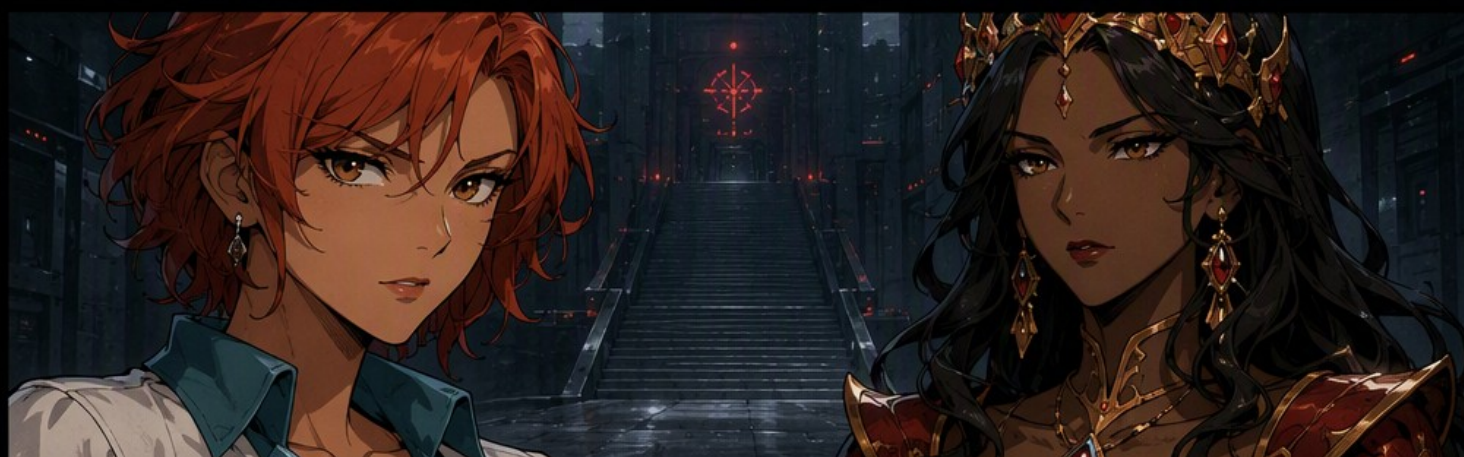
THIS PLACE...

IT'S BUILT
TO IMPRISON,
NOT TO
WELCOME.



IT WAS BUILT
TO REMIND US
THAT MERCY IS
A WEAKNESS.

WE WILL NOT
BE REMINDED.



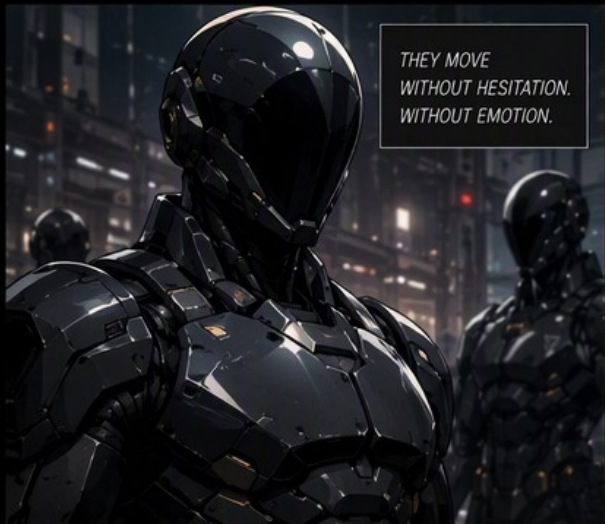
NIGHT SHIFT // LOADING PLATFORM 7B

HMZ-97 AERIAL DEPLOYMENT PAD

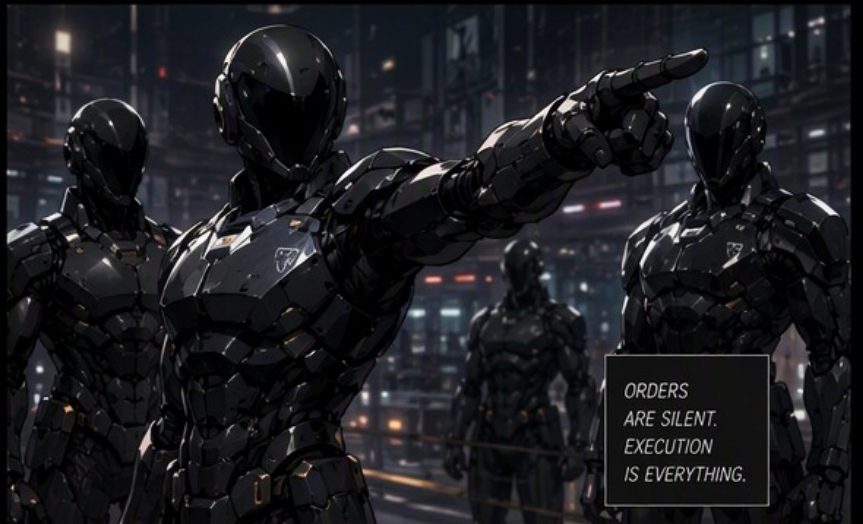
TWO GLIDERS.
ONE TARGET.
ZERO MARGIN
FOR ERROR.



THEY MOVE
WITHOUT HESITATION.
WITHOUT EMOTION.



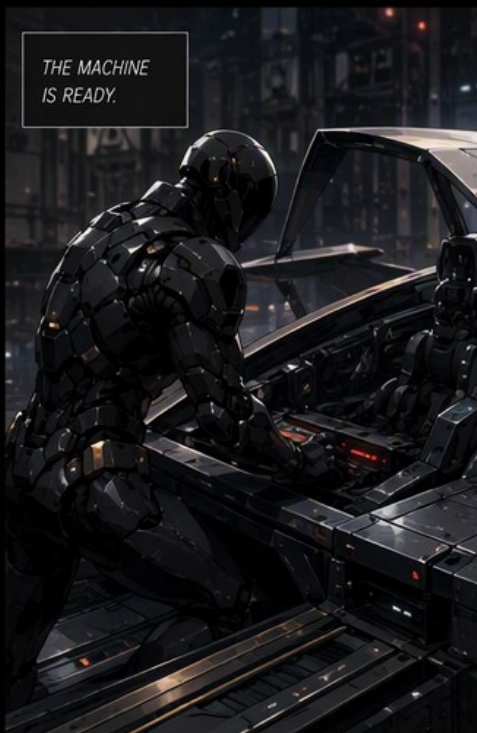
ORDERS
ARE SILENT.
EXECUTION
IS EVERYTHING.



WE ARE
THE HAND.



THE MACHINE
IS READY.



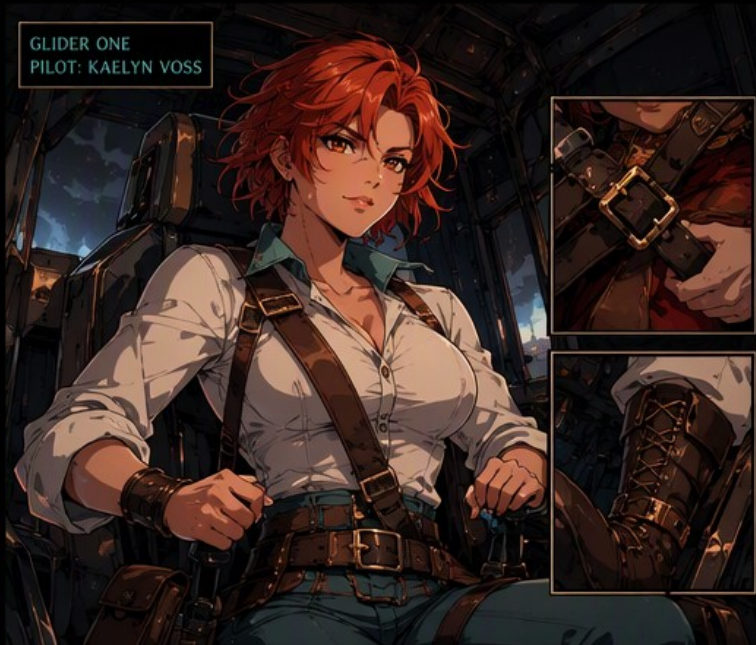
SO ARE WE.



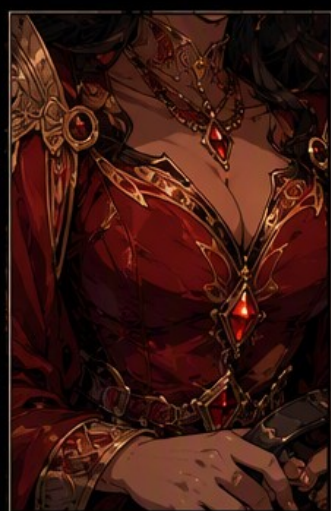
THE EMBER COVEN
FORGE CITY OF AURELIAN
SKYWAYS

STRAP IN.
WE RIDE
THE HEAT.

GLIDER ONE
PILOT: KAELYN VOSS



GLIDER TWO
PILOT: THE
FIRE SOVEREIGN



YOU
READY?



MM.



THE GLIDERS
SHOOT FORWARD
INTO THE PITCH-BLACK
TUNNELS WITH BONE-
CRUSHING
ACCELERATION.



HANG
ON.



I
ALWAYS
DO.



DIVING INTO AN
IMPOSSIBLY STEEP
DROP, SURROUNDED
BY TOTAL DARKNESS.



NO LIGHT.
NO END.
ONLY GRAVITY
AND INSTINCT.

THE TRACK
DOESN'T EXIST.

NOT REALLY.

IT'S SEMI-TRANSLUCENT
STATIC... ABSTRACT
MATTER WITHOUT
FORM.

BUT AT THESE SPEEDS,
WE FORCE IT TO
SOLIDIFY.

FOR JUST A SPLIT
SECOND.

LONG ENOUGH.

RAILS ARE
BURNING.

PUSHING
MAX.

BEHIND US,
IT FADES BACK
INTO NOTHING.

A WHITE VOID.

VANTA ON
MY SIX.

HE'S
CLOSING.

TRY AND
KEEP UP,
GHOST.

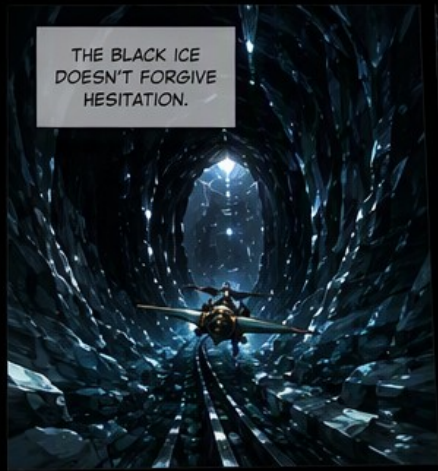
HYPER REALITY RACE

STAGE 7

>> THE ABYSSAL STRAIGHT

THIS ISN'T
A RACE.

IT'S A VIOLATION
OF REALITY.



THE BLACK ICE
DOESN'T FORGIVE
HESITATION.



NO
FRICTION.

NO
MARGIN.



JUST SPEED...

...AND
INSTINCT.



TOO SLOW...

...THE TRACK
EATS ITSELF.



BLACK ICE TUNNEL // SECTOR 7

BAREK HECTOBS

71.3°

MAX DOME

KEEP THE ANGLE.
KEEP THE SPEED.

DON'T THINK.
STEER.



BREATHE.
TRUST
THE LINE.



WHOOOOOSH



THERE.

THAT'S
THE EXIT.

THE GLIDERS BRAKE.



SLIDING INTO A MASSIVE, CAVERNOUS
TERMINAL CARVED FROM RAW ROCK.

THE HIGH-SPEED
THRILL-RIDE ENDING
ABRUPTLY...



WITH NO FANFARE.



白岩ターミナル
SHIRAIWA TERMINAL



THE SILENCE OF THE IMMENSE CAVERN
IMMEDIATELY SWALLOWING THE
ENGINE NOISE.



SHIRAIWA TERMINAL
DEPTH: -1200m
白岩ターミナル

XILTHARA PRIME
CENTRAL TRANSIT TERMINAL
THRONE OF THE HIVE QUEEN

PASSENGER
PACKAGE RECEIVED.

IDENTITY VERIFIED.

CLASSIFICATION
CONFIRMED.

YOU ARE CLEAR
FOR PROCESSING.

PROCEED TO
AUDIT STATION
SEVEN-NINE.

HIVE PROTOCOL
WILL COMMENCE
SHORTLY.

...NEXT.

TWO ORGANICS.

HIGH-VALUE
PROPERTIES.

POTENTIAL
ASSETS.

OR POTENTIAL
CONTAMINANTS.

TIME WILL
DETERMINE.

WE'RE NOT
CARGO.

WE'RE NOT
ANYONE'S
PROPERTY.

CORRECTION.

YOU ARE
TEMPORARY
ENTITIES.

ALL ENTITIES
ARE PROPERTY
OF THE HIVE.

YOUR HIVE MAY
OWN THIS STATION,

BUT IT DOES
NOT OWN US.

DEFIANCE NOTED.

RESISTANCE
IS IRRELEVANT
TO PROCEDURE.

PREPARE FOR
EXTRACTION.

THEN LET'S
SEE HOW
THOROUGH
YOUR
PROCEDURE
REALLY IS.

WE WERE HOPING
FOR DIPLOMACY.

IT SEEMS WE
WILL HAVE TO
SETTLE FOR
SOMETHING
OLDER.



DESIGNATION:
SINGULARITY CORE.
CLASS: OMEGA.
DELIVERY: COMPLETE.

QUEEN VYRAELIS
HIGH HIVE REGENT
SECTOR: N-7 ADMINISTRATUM

HMM.

ACCEPTABLE.
NOT OPTIMAL,
BUT
ACCEPTABLE.

DISMISSED.

AS YOU
ALWAYS DO.

NO
FURTHER
INSTRUCTIONS,
QUEEN.

I WILL
MONITOR.

THE LOWER
REALMS BURN.

IRRELEVANT TO
ADMINISTRATIVE
EFFICIENCY.

LET THEM
SCREAM.

THE HIVE
MUST FUNCTION.

LEAD BY
SILENT HANDS,
WE DESCEND.



...
HOW FAR
ARE WE
GOING?



FAR ENOUGH
TO BE OUT OF
SIGHT.

CLOSE
ENOUGH TO
BE OUT OF
MINDS.



THEN, WITHOUT
WARNING—



KHK



KHKHHK



--THEY TURN.

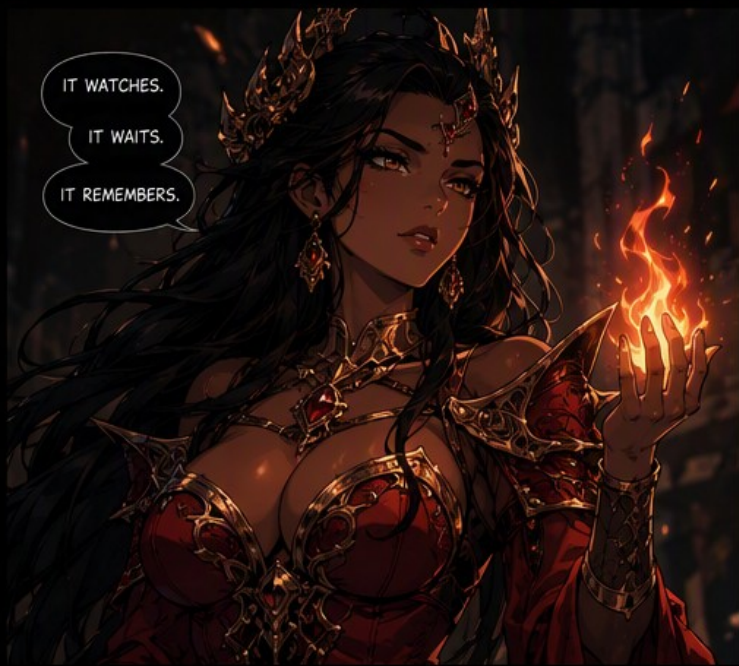


ABANDONED AT
THE EDGE OF THEIR
OPERATIONAL RADIUS.

SOME DOORS
WERE NEVER MEANT
TO BE OPENED.



IT WATCHES.
IT WAITS.
IT REMEMBERS.



THEN LET
IT REMEMBER
US.



THIS ISN'T
A GATE.



IT'S A
THRESHOLD.